

CV – Vera Marie Titze, Ph.D.

Postdoctoral Researcher, Sustainable and Bio-inspired Materials Department, Max Planck Institute of Colloids and Interfaces, Am Mühlenberg 1, Potsdam, Germany

E-mail: vera.titze@mpikg.mpg.de **Phone number:** +49 331 567-9236

ORCID: [0000-0003-0724-7084](https://orcid.org/0000-0003-0724-7084) **Google scholar:** [Vera M Titze](https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=VeraMTitze)

ACADEMIC QUALIFICATIONS

- 08 / 2019 – 06 / 2024 **Ph.D. in Physics** – University of St Andrews, Scotland, UK
Supervisors: Prof. Malte C. Gather, Jun.-Prof. Marcel Schubert
Date of Examination: 26.03.2024
Date of Award: 10.06.2024
- 08 / 2015 – 05 / 2019 **B.Sc. in Physics**, Summa Cum Laude – Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute, Troy, USA

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- 03 / 2026 – present **Minerva Fast Track Group Leader** – Max Planck Institute of Colloids and Interfaces, Sustainable and Bio-inspired Materials, GER
- 06 / 2024 – 02 / 2026 **Postdoctoral researcher** – Max Planck Institute of Colloids and Interfaces, Sustainable and Bio-inspired Materials, GER
- 05 / 2021 – 05 / 2024 **Visiting Ph.D. student** – University of Cologne, Cologne, GER
- 08 / 2019 – 05 / 2021 **Ph.D. student** – University of St Andrews, Scotland, UK

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

- 2026 **ScheringPlus Fellowship** – Awarded to outstanding doctoral candidates and early postdocs in the Berlin–Brandenburg life sciences for interdisciplinary research.
- 2026 **Minerva Fast Track Fellowship** of the Max Planck Society, providing 4-year funding to two female scientists per year to build a research group at a Max Planck Institute.
- 2025 Finalist **Deutscher Studienpreis** der Körber-Stiftung – Shortlisted to the final stage in the Natural Sciences and technology section (Top 11 out of 254 applicants)
- 2024 **Zia Visible Women in Science Fellowship** – Annually awarded to about 25 female early career researchers in Germany (~10% selection rate), ZEIT für X
- 2022 **Invited speaker** – PhD highlight session, showcasing 4 best PhD students across Scotland, Annual gathering of the Scottish University Physics Alliance
- 2021 **Arthur Maitland Prize** – Awarded to one Physics Ph.D. student per year for outstanding research contributions (selected from cohort of 22 students), University of St Andrews
- 2018 **Robert Resnick Award** – Annual award to one B.Sc. student for academic excellence in physics or applied physics (cohort of ~50 students), Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute
- 2018 **CoSIDA Academic All-District Award** – Recognition for performances in athletic competition and in the classroom, received twice (Rensselaer Track & Field and Soccer)
- 2017 **Rensselaer Founders Award of Excellence** – Honors ~70 students per year for creativity, discovery and leadership (~7000 student body), Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute

TEACHING

- 2025 **Lecturer** – 2-Day Python Workshop, Max Planck Institute of Colloids and Interfaces
- 2025 **Lecturer** – Seminar on Light Microscopy for Materials Research, Max Planck Institute of Colloids and Interfaces
- 2022 – 2023 **Lecturer** – Programming Workshop for Physical Chemistry, University of Cologne
- 2022 **Instructor** – Chemistry Grundpraktikum, University of Cologne
- 2020 **Instructor** – Physics 2 Teaching Laboratory, University of St Andrews
- 2018 **Teaching assistant** – Experimental Physics Teaching Laboratory, Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute

SUPERVISION AND MENTORING OF STUDENTS AND EARLY CAREER RESEARCHERS

M. Sc. Student supervision

2024 – present **Name redacted** – Max Planck Institute of Colloids and Interfaces
2023 **Name redacted** – University of Cologne
2022 **Name redacted** – University of Cologne (now Ph.D. student, University of Cologne)

Outreach and Mentoring

2025 Organising a booth on children-friendly microscopy of structurally coloured materials at the **Potsdam Science Day** – Max Planck Institute of Colloids and Interfaces
2024 Invited to deliver a public lecture on how the physics of light can be utilised for sustainability research at the **Zonta Frauensalon Potsdam**
2024 Invited to serve on **Professional Development for Physicists Alumni Panel** – Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute
2016 Introductory Physics **Mentoring Program** – Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

2025 – present **Scientific reviewer** for *Science Advances*, *Advanced Optical Materials*, *Laser & photonics reviews*, *APL Photonics*, and *Optics Communications*
06 / 2025 – present **Research Data Management Officer** – Department of Sustainable and Bio-inspired Materials, Max Planck Institute of Colloids and Interfaces
10 / 2024 – present **Internal Postdoc Representative** – Department of Sustainable and Bio-inspired Materials, Max Planck Institute of Colloids and Interfaces
09 / 2024 - present **Symposium Organizer and Chair** – Annual Early Career Symposium, Max Planck Institute of Colloids and Interfaces (Inaugural Seminar 2025)
08 / 2024 – present **Laser Safety Officer** – Department of Sustainable and Bio-inspired Materials, Max Planck Institute of Colloids and Interfaces
2022 **Seminar Series Organizer** – Securing funding of £1,500 to run “Physics and Astronomy Inclusion, Diversity and Equity Seminar”, University of St Andrews
2022 **Conference Session Chair** – Nanoengineering: Fabrication, Properties, Optics, Thin Films, and Devices XIX, Light-Matter Interaction. SPIE Optics+Photonics, San Diego